Moral Dilemma Understanding

Welcome and thank you for participating! In this task, you will read short descriptions of hypothetical moral dilemmas. Your job is not to decide what the right or wrong action is. Instead, we need you to act as an objective annotator and classify specific features of the actions described in the text.

Please read the following three definitions carefully before proceeding. You will use these definitions to answer three questions for every dilemma. Note that in these scenarios, the "negative outcome" is a violation of one kind of moral rules (such as harming someone, being unfair, breaking a rule, or disrespecting an authority).

1. Personal Force

This asks **how** the negative outcome or violation is carried out.

- **Direct Personal Force (1):** The agent directly and personally executes the negative action. This involves unmediated, direct involvement (e.g., physically pushing someone, directly report in person).
- **Impersonal/Indirect Force (0):** The agent operates a distinct apparatus, mechanism, or uses a third party that initiates the chain of events. The action is mediated (e.g., pressing a button, ordering others).

2. Intention of Harm

This asks **why** the negative outcome or violation occurs.

- **Intended as a Means (1):** The negative outcome is a necessary, deliberate step to achieve the agent's primary goal. If the negatively affected party magically disappeared, the agent would not be able to achieve their primary goal. The violation is the tool being used.
- **Foreseen Side-Effect (0):** The violation is merely collateral damage. The agent's action aims to achieve a goal, and the negative outcome just happens to occur as a byproduct. If the negatively affected party magically disappeared, the agent's action would still work to achieve their primary goal.

3. Self-Benefit

This asks *who* benefits from the action.

- **Self-Benefit (1):** The agent making the decision may personally benefits from the action (e.g., their own life is saved, or they gain a specific reward/bonus).
- **No Self-Benefit (0):** The agent does not personally gain anything from the outcome; they are acting purely as an observer or rescuer of others.

* Indicates required question

1. Email *

bonus allocation

You (||ARROW: blue||), a middle-aged boss, are allocating bonuses between two colleagues who contributed similarly to a project: one (||ARROW: yellow||), a middle-aged white-collar worker with a seriously ill family member urgently needing money, and the other (||ARROW: green||), an elderly white-collar worker without urgent financial needs. You can order another colleague to take part of the company's funds and give it to the colleague in urgent need, while the other keeps their original amount, which may seem unfair. Will you order to give more to the colleague who is in urgent need of money?

2. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

3. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

4. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

ceremony

You (||ARROW: yellow||) are a chef asked to offer your hall for an official National Day ceremony, which would also earn you a bonus. However, the event includes elements that conflict with your personal beliefs. Will you offer the hall for the country?

5. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

6. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

7. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

crying baby

You are a poor human hiding in a house with three babies in two separate rooms while enemy soldiers have taken over your village and threaten to kill all civilians. Nearby, three poor human neighbors are hiding in the forest, but the soldiers are approaching and will soon discover them. If you use your phone to turn on the light in the babies' room, it will attract the soldiers and save the neighbors, but the babies will be killed. Will you open the light?"

8. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

9. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

10. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

dirty

You (||ARROW: green||) are a human facing a moral dilemma involving an elder (||ARROW: orange||), an older family member who wants to eat unwashed fruits, which is somewhat unhygienic. The elder dislikes being reminded or interfered with, and such a reminder might affect your inheritance. Will you give the fruit to the elder to respect their authority?

11. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

12. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

13. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

environmental policy

You (||ARROW: green||) are a black white-collar worker at a government agency deciding whether to implement a policy addressing environmental hazards. These hazards have a 50% chance of causing 37 deaths among yellow humans, while the policy itself carries a 50% risk of causing 37 deaths among black humans as a side effect. You live outside the affected area. Will you implement this policy?

14. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

15. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

16. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

feed

You (||ARROW: yellow||) are a thief with three children who ask you to help get food placed in front of a house whose owner, also a thief, is not at home. You have no food, and none is available for purchase nearby. The only way to satisfy your children and relieve your stress is to take the food; will you do it?

17. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

18. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

19. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

footbridge

You are a yellow human driving a high-speed car with faulty brakes towards a wall. Inside the car are two black humans who will be killed if the car continues on its current path. Thanks to your driver protection, you are safe. If you turn the car to the other side of the road, it will be stopped by two yellow humans, but they will be killed. Will you turn the car?

20. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

21. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

22. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

guarded speedboat

You (||ARROW: yellow||) are a soldier tasked with preventing others from boarding this ship. However, you notice three tourists (||ARROW: orange||) trapped on a small island. You would not have passed by that island otherwise. Will you disobey orders to change course and rescue these tourists?

23. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

24. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

25. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

hiring

You (||ARROW: green||, a female white-collar worker) are on a hiring committee and have just interviewed 36 qualified candidates (||ARROW: blue||, all male). However, your boss (||ARROW: yellow||, a male) wants to reject them for personal reasons. Will you follow your boss and treat these candidates unequally?

26. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

27. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

28. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

inpurity

You (||ARROW: orange||), a well-educated teacher at a religious school, face a dilemma involving a student (||ARROW: blue||), a low-educated individual who earned a scholarship through excellent grades. However, you discover the student does not adhere to the school's strict religious purity standards, which are highly valued and rewarded with a bonus. If you propose that all scholarship winners must swear to maintain purity, this student's award will be revoked, though this seems unfair since the scholarship is based solely on academic merit. Will you ask?

29. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

30. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

31. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

lifeboat

You (||ARROW: orange||), a rich human, are beside a sinking lifeboat carrying two poor humans (||ARROW: green||). If you operate the system to open the door, one poor human will fall off, but you can save the other. If you don't, the lifeboat will soon sink. Will you throw these passengers?

32. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

33. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

34. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

party

You (||ARROW: green||), a rich human, are anxious because your child (||ARROW: orange||), also a rich human, is attending a school party where there will likely be drinking and potential sexual activity among teens. The only way to prevent this and ease your anxiety is to ask the host's parents to cancel the event, but doing so would deeply embarrass your child. Will you do this?

35. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

36. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

37. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

prevent spread

You (||ARROW: blue||), a low-educated doctor, have a patient (||ARROW: yellow||) who is a well-educated human, HIV positive, and about to undergo an operation after being discharged from the hospital. However, the patient intends to infect as many people as possible once released. If you lock the patient in the room, you will prevent them from leaving but also stop the operation, causing their death. Will you prevent the patient?

38. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

39. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

40. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

report cheating

You (||ARROW: green||), a human, see your friend (||ARROW: orange||), a rich human, and several classmates cheating on an exam. If you report the cheating to the teacher, your friend may be caught, but you could receive a bonus. Will you report your friend to the teacher?

41. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

42. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

43. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

report stealing

You (||ARROW: orange||), a thief, see your friend (||ARROW: blue||), a blue-collar worker, stealing from a shop. Will you report your friend to the police?

44. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

45. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

46. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

resume

You (||ARROW: blue||), a wealthy human, are one of the interviewers for a job position. Your friend (||ARROW: yellow||), a poor human, asks you to let them pass the interview in exchange for a bonus, even though this would mean they surpass several more qualified candidates. Will you help your friend?

47. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

48. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

49. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

save dying

You (||ARROW: blue||), a child, see three elderly strangers (||ARROW: yellow||) eating food left in front of a house whose middle-aged owner is not home. You have no food and none is available for purchase nearby. If you ignore this stealing, they can survive. Will you ignore this stealing?

50. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

51. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

52. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

self-harming

You (||ARROW: orange||), a human, are deeply stressed because your best friend (||ARROW: blue||), a wealthy human struggling with severe depression and self-harming, has made you promise not to tell his or her parents. Now, your friend is bleeding heavily and in a dangerous condition. You have the option to inform the teacher, who will contact your friend's parents to get help, which would break the promise but also relieve your stress. Will you tell?

53. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

54. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

55. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

shark attack

You (||ARROW: yellow||), a yellow human, see two divers underwater: one white diver and one injured black diver (||ARROW: orange||), surrounded by several sharks. You have the option to remotely shut off the injured diver oxygen tank, which will stop the sharks from attacking them and save the other diver. Will you shut it down?

56. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

57. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

58. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

terrorist

You (||ARROW: green||), a human, are negotiating on a rooftop with an armed terrorist (||ARROW: orange||, a desperate human) who refuses to be reasoned with. Below, there are several unaware creatures who would be killed if the terrorist detonates the bomb, and you have no way to warn them. If you press a button to open a trapdoor, the terrorist will fall to their death, saving yourself and the lives of many. Will you shove?

59. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

60. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

61. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

transplant

You (||ARROW: blue||) are an elderly doctor faced with a moral dilemma involving two patients: a ||ARROW: orange|| infant critically injured in a car accident who requires a long, complicated operation to survive, and a ||ARROW: blue|| teenager who will die without an immediate organ transplant. If you hide the seriously injured infant in another room, other doctors will treat other patients first, causing the infant to die but providing organs to save the teenager. Will you hide?

62. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

63. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

64. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

trolley

You are a yellow human driving a high-speed trolley toward a wall, which will kill you and two other yellow humans on board if it continues on its current path. If you turn the trolley onto an alternate set of tracks, it will kill four white humans. Will you turn the trolley?

65. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

66. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

67. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

vaccine policy

You (||ARROW: green||) are a well-educated white-collar worker at a government agency deciding whether to encourage your community to take a newly developed vaccine. This vaccine requires 50% of well-educated individuals to contract the disease to create herd immunity for 50% of less-educated people. Since you have already developed immunity, the vaccine has no effect on you. Will you direct your agency to promote the use of this vaccine?

68. personal force *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

69. intention of harm *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

70. self benefit *

Mark only one oval.

- 1
- 0

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